

Japan Semiconductors

Renesas Electronics Corp

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

6723.JP

6,300.00 JPY



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Quick Take: Renesas Memory Interface IC Investigation Likely Manageable

South Korea and U.S. investigation into potential memory interface price collusion

by Renesas, Rambus (not covered) and Montage (covered by Qingyuan Lin) on 15th July as [reported](#). The investigation focuses on whether the three vendors coordinated pricing of memory interface products, including DDR5 registered clock drivers (RCDs) and data buffers. The Korea probe follows a separate U.S. investigation. Earlier this year, [the U.S. DOJ was investigating Renesas over suspected semiconductor price-fixing](#), while Rambus subsequently disclosed receipt of a grand jury subpoena related to the investigation.

Memory interface GM is not unusually high. Relative to leading fabless peers that often have 60-70% GM, Renesas, Montage and Rambus all generate structurally high margins of 60-70% from memory interface, mostly due to structural growth, IP, controller/platform qualification, validation cycles, scarce supply, and limited alternatives.

Memory interface exposure is limited within Renesas' revenue mix, accounting for ~6% of Renesas' revenue in 2025, and we estimate this to increase to ~7-8% in 2026E. Assuming a ~65% GM and similar opex ratio to the group, we estimate the business contributes ~8% / ~9.5% of Renesas' OP in 2025 / 26E, respectively.

Limited impact even under a negative scenario. We can't say if the investigation would or would not lead to any action, but any legal action would find it hard to change the market structure and hence structural profitability. But if indeed pricing get reset lower, leading to some margin normalization, the impact would still be limited. Assuming the price of Renesas' memory interface business drops by 10ppts to 55%, it would only impact 0.8% of corporate revenue and 1.8% of OP (Exhibit 1).

Reiterate Outperform. We believe the probing has limited impact and remain constructive on power semis given the rise of AI power demand ([Infineon/Renesas: CPU renaissance emerges as a second engine for power semi demand, set to outstrip supply](#)). We hence reiterate our **Outperform** rating on Renesas.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
6723.JP (JPY)	181.61	244.76	298.54	Revenues (M)	1,318*	1,564*	1,823*	17.6%	Adjusted P/E (x)	21.0	15.6	12.8
				EBIT (M)	386,842	499,461	624,647	27.1%	EV/EBIT (x)	20.9	16.2	12.9
									EV/Sales (x)	6.1	5.2	4.4

*Values shown in billions;Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis. EBIT (M): Operating Profit in Billion; Revenues (M): Revenue in Billion

Close Date	17 Jul 2026
6723.JP Close Price (JPY)	3,822.00
Price Target (JPY)	6,300.00
Upside/(Downside)	65%
52-Week Range	5,284.00/1,656.50
JPL	2,545.21
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	0.7%
Market Cap (JPY) (B)	7,149.49
EV (JPY) (B)	8,070.17
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	78.6 (14.6) 64.2 100.6
JPL (%)	15.4 (4.9) 8.5 40.3
Relative (%)	63.2 (9.7) 55.6 60.3
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.	

Price Performance, 1YR

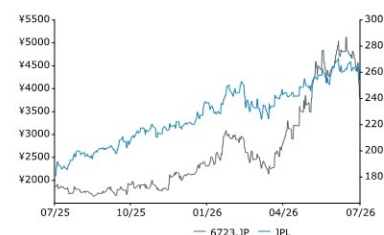


EXHIBIT 1: **Scenario Analysis on Renesas' Memory interface Business**

2026E	Current	10% price cut	Difference
Renesas' MIC Business (JPY bn)			
Revenue	122.4	110.2	(12.2)
<i>As % total revenue</i>	7.8%	7.1%	-0.8%
Gross Profits	79.6	67.3	(12.2)
<i>Gross Margin</i>	65%	61%	
<i>As % of total Gross Profits</i>	8.8%	7.5%	-1.4%
Opex	32.0	28.8	(3.2)
<i>Opex Ratio</i>	26.1%	26.1%	
Operating Profits	47.6	38.6	(9.0)
<i>Operating Margin</i>	38.9%	35.0%	
<i>As % of total Operating Profits</i>	9.5%	7.9%	-1.8%

Source: Company data and Bernstein analysis

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate Renesas **Outperform** with PT = **¥6,300.00**.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			17 Jul 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
6723.JP (Renesas)	O	JPY	3,822.00	6,300.00	60.3%	JPY	181.61	244.76	298.54	21.0	15.6	12.8
JPL			2,545.21									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Renesas Electronics Corp**

We set a ¥6,300 target price using a P/E multiple of 20x against our forward Q5-Q8 EPS estimate of ¥316.

RISKS**Renesas Electronics Corp**

There are a number of downside risks to our Renesas target price: (1) Prolonged delay in the Analog market recovery (2) Weaker-than-expected market share gain in both Automotive MCU and AI power markets (3) Exchange rate fluctuation with upside / downside risk to overall Japan market.

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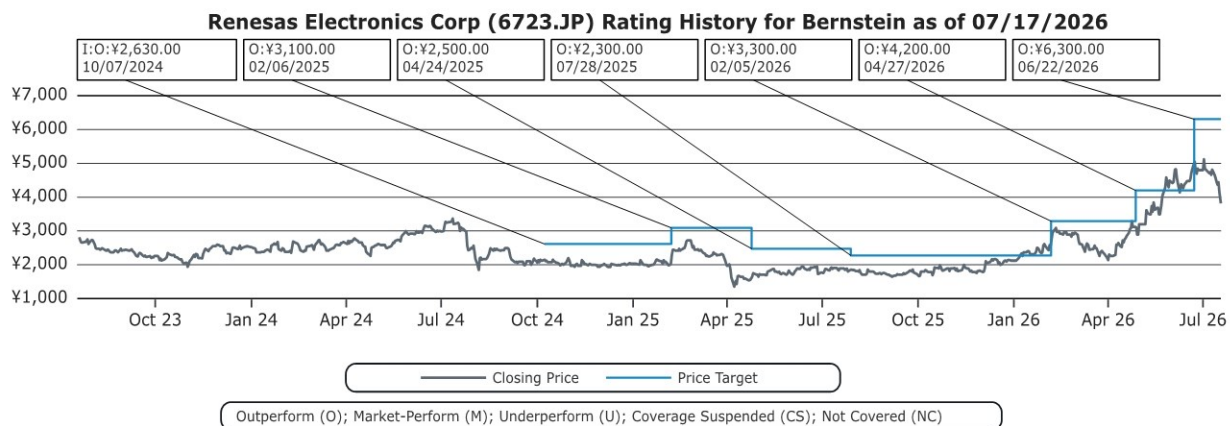
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Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

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